

MODULE 02

AI-Powered Personal Branding & LinkedIn

Optimisation

Participant Workbook

Build a clearer professional identity, strengthen your LinkedIn profile, and track progress with simple career visibility metrics.

You will create or improve:

- A credible LinkedIn profile foundation.
- A clearer headline and About section.
- A keyword map based on real career goals.
- A simple weekly content and relationship plan.
- A 30-day measurement tracker.

What success looks like:

- Your profile explains who you are, who you help, and what value you bring.
- Your profile uses truthful search terms connected to your target roles or opportunities.
- Your activity supports the professional direction you want people to remember.

Before You Begin

This workbook is for ASEAN youth and early-career professionals who want a stronger professional identity online. It supports both beginners who need to create a LinkedIn profile and people who already have one.

Use AI carefully: AI can help you compare, draft, shorten, and improve wording. You are responsible for checking truth, tone, privacy, and relevance before using any suggestion.

Metrics to Record

Metric	Meaning	Where to check	Why it matters
Profile views	People who visited your profile.	Profile analytics	Shows whether more people are checking your professional identity.

Search appearances	Times your profile appeared in LinkedIn search.	Profile analytics	Shows whether your profile is easier to find for relevant terms.
Post impressions	Times your post appeared on screens.	Post analytics	Shows reach of your professional ideas.
Engagement	Reactions, comments, reposts, sends, clicks, and saves.	Post analytics	Shows whether people respond to your activity.
Follower growth	People choosing to see more from you.	Profile analytics	Shows growing interest in your professional direction.
Social Selling Index (SSI)	LinkedIn's score for professional brand, finding the right people, engaging with insights, and building relationships.	LinkedIn Sales Solutions SSI page	Helps you identify which relationship-building habit needs work.

Baseline Tracker

Metric	Today	7 days	14 days	30 days	Notes
Profile views					
Search appearances					
Followers					
Average post impressions					
Average engagement per post					
Social Selling Index (SSI)					

Table of Contents

Use this page to plan your learning path and return to the section you need.

Section	What you will do
Before You Begin	Record baseline metrics and understand how progress will be measured.
Chapter 1: Create Your LinkedIn Foundation	Create a LinkedIn profile or complete the essential profile sections.
Chapter 2: See Your Profile Like a Recruiter	Review first impressions and identify the highest-priority profile improvements.
Chapter 3: Build a Clear Professional Promise With AI	Use AI to organize real experience into a clear, truthful positioning statement.
Chapter 4: Rewrite Your Headline and About Section	Draft and edit a stronger headline and About opening.
Chapter 5: Make the Profile Searchable and Credible	Use relevant search terms naturally and strengthen credibility signals.
Chapter 6: Publish, Connect, and Improve Over 30 Days	Plan useful posts, comments, connection requests, and ongoing measurement.
30-Day Improvement Sprint	Commit to profile, content, relationship, and measurement actions.
Reference Notes	Review the source basis for the profile and measurement guidance.

Chapter 1: Create Your LinkedIn Foundation

Start With This

Look at the two situations below. Mark which one is closest to you today.

Example: Ari has no LinkedIn account and needs a professional starting point. Mei has an account but no clear headline, no About section, and no recent activity. Both can improve by building the same foundation: identity, credibility, and a simple next step.

Situation	Closest to me?	What I need first
I do not have a LinkedIn profile yet.		
I have a LinkedIn profile, but it is incomplete.		
I have a LinkedIn profile and want to improve visibility.		

Think It Through

When someone searches your name or views your profile, what should they understand about you in the first 30 seconds?

Build the Foundation

A useful LinkedIn profile starts with accurate identity information, a clear profile photo, education or experience history, a headline, an About section, skills, and a simple contact or connection path.

Step 1: Create or open your account

Go to LinkedIn, sign up or log in, and use the name you normally use in professional or academic settings. Use an email account you can access long term.

Example: Use the name shown on your internship certificate and university records so recruiters can recognize you.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Step 2: Add profile essentials

Complete your location, education, current role or student status, industry, and a clear profile photo. Avoid outdated, cropped, or overly casual photos.

Example: A final-year student adds 'Jakarta, Indonesia', their university, field of study, and a clean head-and-shoulders photo.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Step 3: Choose a simple profile address

Edit your public profile address if available so it is easy to share on a CV, portfolio, or email signature.

Example: Instead of a long random address, use a cleaner format based on your name when it is available.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Step 4: Add the first credibility signals

Add education, projects, internships, volunteer work, certificates, skills, and one piece of featured work if you have it. Keep every claim truthful.

Example: You might add a student research project, a portfolio link, three relevant skills, and a certificate from a completed online course.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Practice

Complete the profile foundation checklist. If you already have a profile, use the checklist to identify missing sections.

Example: If you do not have a profile yet, complete account setup, photo, education, location, headline draft, and three skills. If you already have a profile, improve the photo, edit the public address, and add a featured portfolio link.

☐	My name is professional and recognizable.
☐	My location and education or role are accurate.
☐	My photo is clear and appropriate for professional viewers.
☐	My public profile address is shareable.
☐	My profile includes at least three relevant skills.
☐	My profile includes at least one project, work sample, certificate, or activity that supports my direction.

Check Your Understanding

Which action is most useful for someone who does not yet have LinkedIn?

- A. Publish daily posts before completing the profile
- B. Create the account and complete the profile foundation first
- C. Add skills that sound impressive but are not real

Answer: B. A complete and truthful foundation makes later improvements easier to measure.

Chapter 2: See Your Profile Like a Recruiter

Start With This

Open two LinkedIn profiles in your target field. Spend only 30 seconds on each profile and note what you understand.

Example: Profile A says 'Marketing Student'. Profile B says 'Marketing graduate helping education programs turn event stories into social content'. Profile B is easier to understand because it names direction, audience, and value.

Profile	What they do	Who they help	Credibility signal	What is unclear
A				
B				
My profile				

Think It Through

What did the stronger profile make clear quickly? What should your own profile make clear just as quickly?

Learn the Method

A strong profile answers three questions quickly: What do you do? Who benefits? Why should they trust you? The top sections should point to the same professional promise.

☐	The photo is current, clear, and professional.
☐	The headline says more than a job title.
☐	The About opening explains value in the first two lines.
☐	Experience or project bullets show outcomes, not only tasks.

☐	Featured work shows real capability.
☐	Skills match the work the person wants to be found for.
☐	Recommendations or endorsements support the claimed strengths.
☐	Recent posts or comments show professional interests.
☐	The profile uses terms a recruiter, employer, client, or collaborator would search for.
☐	The profile gives a simple next step: connect, message, view portfolio, or read a featured item.

Practice

Score your profile out of 10 using the checklist. Choose the three lowest-scoring items as your first improvement priorities.

Example: If your score is 5 out of 10 and the weakest items are headline, About opening, and Featured work, start by rewriting the headline and About opening before adding new media.

My score	Priority 1	Priority 2	Priority 3	Why these matter

Check Your Understanding

Which section should usually be improved first if people cannot understand your value quickly?

- A. A longer list of hobbies
- B. A clearer headline and About opening
- C. More decorative wording

Answer: B. The top of the profile shapes the first impression and helps people decide whether to continue.

Chapter 3: Build a Clear Professional Promise With AI

Start With This

Write your current professional promise in one sentence. Then write what a recruiter, employer, client, or mentor should remember after viewing your profile.

Example: Current: 'I am a communications graduate interested in digital marketing.' Stronger: 'I help student organizations turn events into social content that improves attendance and sponsor visibility.'

My current sentence	What I want people to remember	Audience I want to attract

Think It Through

What part of your value is already clear? What part feels too generic, too broad, or unsupported?

Learn the Method

Use AI to organize your real material: achievements, projects, testimonials, work samples, target roles, and audience language. The strongest output is specific, truthful, and easy to say aloud.

Prompt: Act as a LinkedIn profile editor. I will give you my current headline, About section, target audience, career goals, achievements, and work samples. Create three positioning options. Each option must include audience, problem, outcome, and credibility signal. Flag any claim that sounds vague or unsupported.

Step 1: Collect your raw material

Gather your current headline, About section, role descriptions, three achievements, target job titles or client types, and links to work you are proud of.

Example: A fresh graduate collects internship projects, volunteer leadership examples, campus event numbers, certificates, and three target roles.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Step 2: Ask AI for positioning options

Paste the material into your AI tool and ask for three options. Request plain language, not exaggerated marketing language.

Example: Option 1 focuses on content planning. Option 2 focuses on employer branding. Option 3 focuses on community growth. Choose the option closest to your real work.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Step 3: Human-edit the best option

Remove anything that does not sound like you. Replace vague words with concrete audience, problem, outcome, or work sample.

Example: AI suggests 'dynamic marketing professional'. You rewrite it as 'entry-level content marketer who helps education communities turn event stories into posts people can act on'.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Practice

Create your one-sentence professional promise and test it with the checklist.

Example: I help early-stage food brands turn customer feedback into clearer product stories for Instagram, LinkedIn, and pitch decks.

Field	My answer
Audience	
Problem	
Outcome	

Credibility signal	
Final sentence	
☐	It names a clear audience.
☐	It explains a real problem or goal.
☐	It points to an outcome.
☐	It is truthful today.
☐	It sounds like something I could say in conversation.

Check Your Understanding

Which sentence is the clearest professional promise?

- A. I am passionate about innovation and leadership.
- B. I help early-career designers turn portfolio projects into clearer case studies for product teams.
- C. I am hardworking, adaptable, and results-oriented.

Answer: B. It names the audience, action, and outcome.

Chapter 4: Rewrite Your Headline and About Section

Start With This

Compare the two examples. Underline the words that make the second version easier to understand.

Before: Business Development | Sales | Communication | Teamwork

After: Business Development Associate helping Indonesian education partners build employer relationships and youth career programs

Think It Through

What does your current headline say about your value? What important audience, outcome, or specialty is missing?

Learn the Method

A strong headline uses this structure: role or expertise + audience + value + optional credibility signal. The About section expands it in a warm, human voice.

Headline part	Question to answer	My notes
Role or expertise	What work do I want to be known for?	
Audience	Who should care?	
Value	What outcome do I help create?	
Credibility signal	What makes this believable?	

About structure: 1. Start with the problem or mission. 2. Say who you help and how. 3. Add two or three credibility signals. 4. Share the opportunities you welcome. 5. End with a simple invitation to connect.

Step 1: Draft five headline options

Ask AI for five headline options using your professional promise. Keep only the options that are specific, truthful, and easy to scan.

Example: AI offers: 'Data Analyst | Turning survey data into service improvement insights for education programs'. Keep it if it names your work and audience clearly.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Step 2: Choose one readable headline

Select a headline that sounds professional without being inflated. Remove overused labels such as guru, ninja, and world-class unless they are genuinely used in your field.

Example: Change 'world-class strategic storyteller' to a clearer version such as 'communications specialist helping nonprofits turn program results into donor-ready stories'.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Step 3: Draft the About section

Give AI your chosen headline, professional promise, achievements, and target audience. Ask for a first-person About section with short paragraphs.

Example: Ask for a version that sounds confident, warm, and suitable for ASEAN youth career opportunities.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Step 4: Edit for truth and tone

Read the About section aloud. Keep concrete examples. Remove claims you cannot explain in an interview or client conversation.

Example: If AI writes 'I transformed national education systems', edit it to a truthful version such as 'I supported a university team in improving event communication for 800 students'.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Practice

Write your final headline and the first two lines of your About section. These two areas should make your value clear before anyone scrolls.

Example: Headline: Talent Development Coordinator helping youth programs turn learning activities into measurable career readiness outcomes. About opening: I design practical learning experiences for students and early-career professionals who need clearer confidence, employability, and workplace communication.

Final headline	About opening line 1	About opening line 2	Generic phrase I removed

Check Your Understanding

True or false: A headline should only repeat your current job title.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

Answer: B. A job title can be included, but the headline should also explain value.

Chapter 5: Make the Profile Searchable and Credible

Start With This

Imagine a recruiter searching for someone like you. Write five words or phrases they might type into LinkedIn search.

Example: For a junior data role: data analyst, Excel dashboard, SQL, survey analysis, business intelligence.

Search phrase 1	Search phrase 2	Search phrase 3	Search phrase 4	Search phrase 5

Think It Through

Which of those words already appear in your headline, About section, experience, skills, or recent activity? Which important words are missing?

Learn the Method

Search visibility improves when your profile uses the same truthful language your target audience uses. Use AI to compare your profile with target job descriptions, role descriptions, or client problem statements, then add the most relevant terms naturally.

Prompt: Compare my LinkedIn profile text with these target role descriptions. Identify repeated skills, tools, industries, problems, and outcomes. Rank the terms by relevance. Suggest natural places to add them without keyword stuffing.

Step 1: Build a keyword map

Paste five target job descriptions, project briefs, or ideal client descriptions into AI. Ask for repeated role, skill, tool, industry, and outcome terms.

Example: AI identifies repeated terms: stakeholder management, Excel, dashboard, research, customer insight, and report writing.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Step 2: Add terms naturally

Add the strongest truthful terms to your headline, About section, experience bullets, skills, and content topics. Use complete sentences where possible.

Example: Instead of repeating 'Excel', write a natural sentence such as: 'Built Excel dashboards to summarize student attendance and feedback trends for program managers'.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Step 3: Update credibility areas

Review your photo, background image, public profile address, Featured area, experience entries, skills, certifications, and recommendations. Improve the areas that support your chosen promise.

Example: If you want brand roles, add a campaign case study to Featured, list brand strategy and content planning as skills, and request one recommendation from a project supervisor.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Practice

Choose three profile sections to update today. Each update should support the same professional promise.

Example: A project manager updates the headline, adds two outcome-based experience bullets, and features a project timeline document.

Profile section	Current state	New wording or action	Metric to check later
Headline			Profile views / search appearances
Experience			Search appearances

Featured			Profile activity / messages
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Check Your Understanding

Which keyword habit is most useful?

- A. Repeating the same keyword many times
- B. Using relevant terms naturally in sections where they make sense
- C. Adding popular skills you do not actually have

Answer: B. Natural, truthful language helps both readers and search.

Chapter 6: Publish, Connect, and Improve Over 30 Days

Start With This

Look at your recent LinkedIn activity. What would someone learn about your interests, values, and expertise from your last three posts or comments?

Example: If you want HR roles but your activity is mostly unrelated, start commenting weekly on hiring, learning, youth employment, and workplace communication topics.

Recent activity	What it says about me	Keep, improve, or stop?
Post/comment 1		
Post/comment 2		
Post/comment 3		

Think It Through

What topics would make the right people trust your professional direction more? What conversations would you be proud for a recruiter, employer, client, or mentor to see?

Learn the Method

Your profile becomes stronger when your content and relationships support your professional promise. Use AI to turn real experience into useful posts, thoughtful comments, and personalized connection messages. Keep the final wording human and specific.

Content type	Best use	Simple structure
Lesson post	Show what you learned from a real task.	Situation + lesson + practical takeaway

Before/after post	Show improvement in a project, process, or thinking.	Before + change + after + what others can apply
Resource post	Share a checklist, tool, template, or reading list.	Who it helps + resource + how to use it
Comment	Build relationships without sending cold pitches.	Specific appreciation + useful addition + genuine question
Connection message	Start a relevant professional relationship.	Context + shared interest + simple reason to connect

Prompt: Turn this project experience into three LinkedIn post drafts. Each draft should be useful to my target audience, avoid exaggeration, and end with a thoughtful question. Keep it concise.

Step 1: Create a weekly content bank

List five real experiences, lessons, projects, or resources. Ask AI to turn them into post ideas connected to your professional promise.

Example: List a campus event, internship dashboard, volunteer project, failed presentation, and favorite learning resource. AI can turn them into five practical post ideas.

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Step 2: Publish one useful post

Choose one idea, edit it in your own voice, and publish it. Use a clear opening line and one practical takeaway.

Example: Opening line: 'I used to think event promotion was just posting often. After tracking attendance across three student events, I learned timing matters more than volume.'

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Step 3: Leave five thoughtful comments

Find posts from people in your target field. Add comments that show understanding and contribute something useful. Avoid generic comments such as 'Great post'.

Example: Comment: 'The point about candidate follow-up resonates. In student programs, we saw better attendance when reminders included one concrete benefit, not only the schedule.'

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Step 4: Send three relevant connection requests

Write short, personal messages to people connected to your target field. Mention the context, not a pitch.

Example: Message: 'Hi Rani, I saw your post about youth employability programs. I am building my experience in career readiness and would value staying connected with your work.'

Visual record area

Add the image or visual note that helps you remember this step.

Practice

Plan your next seven days. Keep the actions small enough to complete consistently.

Example: Monday: update headline. Tuesday: publish one lesson post. Wednesday: comment on five HR posts. Friday: check post analytics and note one learning.

Day	Action	Topic or profile section	Metric to observe
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Check Your Understanding

Which outreach message is strongest?

- A. Please hire me, I am available immediately.

- B. Hi, I saw your post about youth career programs. I am learning about employability training and would value staying connected with your work.
- C. Hi, please endorse all my skills.

Answer: B. It is specific, respectful, and relevant.

30-Day Improvement Sprint

Use this page to keep your profile active and measurable. The goal is consistent improvement, not perfection.

Week	Profile improvement	Content action	Relationship action	Numbers to record
1	Create or complete the foundation.	Publish one lesson post if your profile is ready.	Comment on five relevant posts.	Profile views, search appearances
2	Rewrite headline and About opening.	Publish one before/after post.	Send three relevant connection requests.	Post impressions, engagement
3	Update experience, skills, and Featured work.	Publish one resource post.	Ask for one recommendation if appropriate.	Followers, messages
4	Review all top sections.	Repurpose the best post idea.	Follow up with useful context.	Social Selling Index (SSI), trend notes

Final Reflection

What changed in your profile? What changed in how you explain your professional value? What will you keep doing for the next 30 days?

Personal Commitment

My next profile update	My next post topic	My next relationship action	Date I will review metrics

Reference Notes

These sources support the workbook's focus on profile completeness, discoverability, profile strength, professional-brand scoring, and AI-assisted drafting with human review.

- LinkedIn Help: 'Create a good LinkedIn profile' explains that a complete profile increases discoverability and profile search appearances.
<https://www.linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a554351/>
- LinkedIn Marketing Solutions Help: 'Use the profile level meter to update your profile' explains that the profile level meter shows completeness and can help improve search discoverability.
<https://www.linkedin.com/help/lms/answer/a594698>
- LinkedIn Sales Solutions: 'Social Selling Index' describes Social Selling Index (SSI) as measurement across professional brand, finding the right people, engaging with insights, and building relationships. <https://business.linkedin.com/sales-solutions/learning-center/resources/guides/g001/en-en/ts007>
- LinkedIn Help: 'Enhance your profile with LinkedIn's AI-powered writing assistant' describes AI assistance for Headline, About, and Experience profile sections.
<https://www.linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a1444194>
- Noy, S. and Zhang, W. (2023). 'Experimental evidence on the productivity effects of generative artificial intelligence,' Science, 381(6654), 187-192. The study found productivity and quality gains for professional writing tasks, supporting AI as a drafting and revision aid when the user verifies the final content. DOI: 10.1126/science.adh2586